

Hindu art

Rajput or Rajasthani painting emerged from Hindu India at the end of the 16th century. Characterized by bold drawing and vibrant colours, most paintings were miniatures, although some were larger, decorating walls of palaces and other important buildings. Rajasthani artists idealized feminine beauty and expressed love scenes, stories from Krishna's life and landscapes in precise detail. The style evolved and flourished in the royal courts of Rajputana, and each Rajput kingdom developed a distinct style, albeit with certain common features, combining Persian, Mughal, Chinese and European influences.

The Pahari School developed in the foothills of Punjab, Garhwal and Jammu, and became known for flat images painted with flowing lines and brilliant colours. Influenced by Mughal art, Pahari paintings were mostly miniatures, and developed and flourished from the 17th to the 19th century. After Delhi was sacked in 1739, many Mughal artists went to Rajput courts and synthesized their styles with Pahari paintings.



Unknown artist, *Rama and Sita*, c.1780